

Contractable Concepts

Resources

Resources define the **labour roles** used when estimating project costs and building budgets. Before you can price work or forecast profit, Contractable needs to know what types of labour your business uses — and what each type costs per hour.

What is a Resource?

A Resource is a **skill type or role**, not a named individual. Think of it as a labour category that represents a particular kind of work your workforce performs.

For example, you might define resources like:

- **Electrician** — licensed tradesperson performing electrical installation
- **Apprentice (1st Year)** — supervised entry-level labour at a lower cost rate
- **Project Manager** — site coordination and client-facing oversight
- **Site Supervisor** — day-to-day crew management and quality control

Each resource carries an **average hourly cost rate**. When you build a project estimate, you assign resource types to tasks — and Contractable uses those rates to calculate labour costs, total project budgets, and expected profit margins automatically.

Resources vs. Workers

It's important to understand the distinction:

	What it is	Where it's managed
Resource	A role or skill type (e.g. "Electrician")	Resources (this section)
Worker	A real person assigned to that role	Workforce Management

You set up your resource types here first. Later, in **Workforce Management**, you assign individual workers to the resource type that matches their role. This separation keeps your cost modelling clean — if your electrician rates change, you update the resource once and it flows through to all your estimates.

Why This Matters

Getting your resources right at the start pays off throughout the project lifecycle. Accurate hourly rates mean your estimates reflect real costs, your budgets hold up under scrutiny, and your profit forecasting gives you numbers you can actually trust.

Users & User Roles

Contractable is used by different people across your business — estimators, site supervisors, office managers, executives — and not everyone should see or do the same things. User Roles are how you control exactly what each person can access, and what they can change.

Every user in Contractable must be assigned a role. Before you can add users, you need to define what roles exist in your organisation.

What is a User Role?

A User Role is a named permission profile. It defines, module by module, what a user assigned to that role can see and do inside Contractable.

Roles are fully custom — there are no preset roles that ship with the system. You build each role from scratch to match the actual structure of your business. A role might be called "Estimator", "Site Supervisor", "Finance Manager", or anything else that reflects how your team is organised. The name is yours; the permissions are yours to configure.

Each user is assigned exactly one role. That role determines their entire experience of Contractable — what appears in their navigation, what data they can view, and what they can edit or action.

Read Only vs. Edit

Every module in Contractable can be granted to a role in one of two ways:

- **Read Only** — the user can view information in that module but cannot make changes
- **Edit** — the user can view and make changes, create records, and update data

If a module is not granted at all, users with that role will not see it.

This two-level structure keeps things straightforward. An office manager might have Edit access to Customer Management but Read Only access to Global Settings. A site supervisor might have no access to Finance at all. You configure each module independently for each role.

The Permission Modules

When building a role, you configure access across the following modules:

Operational Modules

Module	Access Options
Dashboard	Read Only
Customer Management	Read Only / Edit
Suppliers Management	Read Only / Edit
Contractors Management	Read Only / Edit
Resource & Material Catalogs	Read Only / Edit
Template Management	Read Only / Edit
Inventory	Read Only / Edit
Asset Management	Read Only / Edit

Project Access

Project access is configured **per Project Category** — meaning you can grant a role access to one category of project but not another. For example, a role might have full access to MINOR projects but only Read Only access to MAJOR projects.

Each project category has an additional **Finance checkbox** that independently controls whether users with that role can see financial data within those projects. A role can have Edit access to a project category but still be restricted from

seeing its financial figures.

Module	Access Options
Project [CATEGORY]	Read Only / Edit + Finance checkbox (per category)

Workforce & Finance

Module	Access Options	Additional Permission
Workforce Management	Read Only / Edit	Timesheet Approver — grants the ability to approve timesheets submitted by workers
Finance	Read Only / Edit	Global financial module access across all projects

Administration

Module	Access Options	Additional Permission
User Management	Read Only / Edit	Administrator — grants the ability to create and manage users and roles
Global Settings Management	Read Only	Configuration visibility; not editable by any role below system level

Special Permissions

Two modules carry additional checkboxes beyond Read Only and Edit. These grant specific elevated capabilities that are separate from general access:

Timesheet Approver (within Workforce Management) — a user with this permission can review and approve timesheets. Without it, a user with Edit access to Workforce Management can still manage workforce records but cannot approve time.

Administrator (within User Management) — a user with this permission can create, edit, and deactivate users and roles. This is a high-trust permission and should be limited to those responsible for managing your Contractable account.

The Right Order: Roles Before Users

Because every user must be assigned a role at the point they are created, roles must exist before users are added. The correct setup sequence is:

- 1. **Plan your roles** — map out the types of users in your organisation and what each needs to access
- 2. **Create the roles** in User Management → Define User Role
- 3. **Add your users** and assign each one to their role

If your organisation's access requirements are straightforward, you may only need two or three roles. Larger or more complex organisations — with stricter separation between operational and financial data, or between project categories — may need more. There is no fixed limit.

A Note on Financial Access

Financial data in Contractable is protected at two levels — the global Finance module, and the per-category Finance checkbox on individual project types. This means a user can be given full operational access to projects without ever seeing cost, margin, or budget data unless you explicitly grant it.

For most businesses, financial visibility is something to grant deliberately rather than by default. When configuring roles, consider carefully who genuinely needs to see financial figures — and limit that access accordingly.

Catalogs & Materials

Materials are the products, supplies, and physical items your business uses to complete work. Before you can include material costs in a project estimate, Contractable needs to know what those materials are and what they cost. The Materials module is where you build and manage that price list.

Catalogs are how you keep that list organised.

What is a Material?

A Material is any product or supply item that can be added to a project estimate or allocated to a project for cost tracking. Each material carries a **standard cost** (what you pay for it) and optionally a **sale price or markup** (what you charge the customer).

Materials are not just for estimating — once a project is underway, they can be allocated against it so your actual material spend is tracked against budget in real time.

What is a Catalog?

A Catalog is a named grouping of materials — typically organised by supplier or category. Rather than scrolling through hundreds of items when building an estimate, catalogs let you navigate directly to the right supplier or material type.

For example, you might create catalogs like:

- **Rexel** — electrical supplies from your Rexel account
- **CNW** — cable and conduit products
- **Ideal Electrical** — switchgear and distribution
- **Consumables** — miscellaneous workshop and site items

Every material belongs to a catalog. Setting up your catalogs first makes adding and finding materials much faster.

Material Types

Not all materials work the same way. Contractable supports three types:

Type	What it is	Typical use
External Materials	Items purchased from suppliers and on-charged to the customer	Standard project materials with cost + markup
Internal Materials	Items drawn from your own stock or inventory	Materials you already own and allocate to jobs
Mobile Materials	Items accessible from the mobile/field app	On-site recording of materials used at time of use

When adding a material, you'll select the type that matches how that item flows through your business.

Managing Your Materials

Adding Materials

ADD MATERIAL lets you manually enter a single item. You'll provide:

- A description (the material name as it will appear in estimates)
- The catalog it belongs to
- A category (for further grouping within a catalog)
- A part number (optional, for matching supplier references)
- A standard cost (your purchase price)
- A sale lock setting (whether the sale price can be changed at estimate time)

IMPORT MATERIALS lets you load a large number of items at once from a CSV or spreadsheet file. The file must match the Contractable import template — your Customer Support or Pro Services team can provide this. Bulk import is the recommended approach for any catalog of 20 or more items.

Keeping Materials Current

SWAP MATERIAL replaces one material with another across all existing project quotes. Use this when a product is discontinued or replaced by a newer equivalent — rather than editing every quote manually, a single swap updates them all.

DUPLICATES identifies materials that appear more than once in your catalog, so you can review and consolidate them. Duplicate entries cause inconsistent pricing in estimates and are worth resolving early.

MOVE ITEMS transfers materials from one catalog to another. Useful when reorganising your supplier structure or correcting items added to the wrong catalog.

A Suggested Starting Point

If you're setting up Materials for the first time:

1. **Create your catalogs first** — one per major supplier or category
2. **Import or enter your most-used materials** — focus on what appears regularly in estimates
3. **Check standard costs** — make sure they reflect your current supplier pricing
4. **Set sale locks where needed** — protect margins on items that should never be discounted at estimate time

You don't need a complete price list before you start estimating. Add materials as you need them and build out the catalog progressively.

Task & Item Templates

If your business regularly quotes the same type of work — running conduit, installing a switchboard, fitting off a bathroom — you shouldn't have to rebuild that estimate from scratch every time. Task and Item Templates let you pre-build the components of an estimate once, then drop them into any project quote with a few clicks.

Templates are shared across all projects and can be updated at any time.

The Building Blocks: Items and Tasks

To understand templates, it helps to first understand how Contractable structures an estimate.

An **Item** is a single line of work — one material, one resource (labour), and a planned effort in hours. It represents the smallest unit of estimating: one thing, its cost, and how long it takes.

A **Task** is a group of Items that together make up a complete piece of work. Where an Item is a single component, a Task captures the full scope — all the materials and labour required to complete a defined job from start to finish.

For example:

- An **Item** might be: *100 × 87 DWV Sew. Bend — \$5.49 material, 0.1 hrs labour*
- A **Task** might be: *R-VENT* — which groups together three or four Items (fittings, pipe, fixings) with their combined material cost, resource cost, planned hours, and a rolled-up total

Item Templates

An Item Template is a saved, reusable version of a single estimating line. It stores:

- The material (from your catalog)
- The contractor cost (if applicable)
- The resource type and its cost rate
- The planned effort in hours
- The calculated total

When you find yourself adding the same component repeatedly across different jobs, saving it as an Item Template means you enter the details once and reuse them indefinitely.

Task Templates

A Task Template is a saved, reusable group of Items — a complete unit of work, pre-priced and ready to apply to a quote.

From the screenshots, a Task Template like **R-VENT** might contain:

Item	Material	Resource	Planned Effort	Total
110 DWV Fix. Vert. (Concrete)	\$37.92	\$43.17	0.3 hrs	\$81.09
110 × 85 Plain DWV Bend	\$8.44	\$11.51	0.08 hrs	\$19.95
110 × 110 × 45 Plain DWV Junction & 60° Bend	\$35.75	\$13.67	0.1 hrs	\$49.42
Task Total	\$82.11	\$68.35	0.48 hrs	\$150.46

When you apply this Task Template to a project quote, all of those lines — with their costs and hours — come in as a single action. The estimate builds itself.

Item Template vs. Task Template

	Item Template	Task Template
What it represents	A single estimating line	A complete unit of work
Contains	One material + one resource + hours	Multiple items grouped together

Best used for	Frequently used components	Frequently quoted scopes of work
Applied to a quote as	One line	Multiple lines, grouped under a task

Why Templates Matter

The value of templates compounds over time. The first time you build a Task Template, it takes roughly the same effort as doing the estimate manually. But from the second job onward, that scope of work takes seconds to add — accurately, consistently, and with current pricing already built in.

Because templates are shared across all projects, everyone quoting from the same library is working from the same rates and the same labour assumptions. That consistency removes a common source of estimating error and makes it much easier to compare project performance against forecast.

When material costs or resource rates change, update the template once — future quotes using it will reflect the new figures.

A Suggested Approach

If you're setting up templates for the first time:

1. **Start with your most repeated work types** — the scopes you quote every week
2. **Build Item Templates first** for your most common materials and labour combinations
3. **Group them into Task Templates** for complete, repeatable scopes
4. **Review your templates periodically** to keep costs aligned with current supplier pricing and resource rates